

F1 Round 2 — gaps, free routes, template v3 and the road to G3

Sep 29, 2026 · @Mohammad AlFalasi

F1 stays free and keeps the option to charge later: every asset carries its licence class, so a paid build drops non-commercial items and swaps in a recorded fallback. This round checked F1 against seven outside benchmarks and found one structural gap (peoples named in their own terms) and fourteen themes. It grew the canon to 4,228 nodes, drafted five grouping pages, wrote template v3 and issued Historian pack v2. What remains before G3 is mostly unit specs and the harvest.

Q28 answered: free now, able to charge later

You said F1 is not charged today and you want to keep the option. So the rule is: host only media safe for commercial use by default, and make every other item switchable rather than excluded. Three mechanics do it.

1. **A licence class on every asset.** Each image, model, sound or text carries one of six classes: public domain or CC0; national open licence; attribution (CC BY or BY-SA); our own work; non-commercial by permission; link-out only. The class comes from the harvest, not from typing.
2. **Two builds from one dataset.** The open build may show items a holder has permitted for free education. The commercial build filters them out automatically. The day F1 charges, one setting changes and nothing is rewritten.
3. **A fallback recorded for every restricted item.** Every non-commercial or permission-only item names its replacement: an open object of the same kind, our own drawing, the living practice, or a link out. The switch never leaves a hole in a walk.

One caution, and I am not a lawyer: Creative Commons defines non-commercial by purpose, so a free course run by a company can still count as commercial. Until F1's legal home is settled, treat non-commercial licences as link-out and ask holders for permission instead (§2, option 2).

More ways to keep it free

Scope v2 gave a free route for every budget line. These eleven options add to them; the first three matter most now.

#	Option	What it gets F1	What it costs instead
1	A free harvest runtime: a public code repository whose scheduled jobs run the harvester and write the data files	The harvest at full scale, with no credits spent. The scraping connector works but uses your Firecrawl credits per call	A repository to create (Q38); public data is then visible to anyone, which suits an open Atlas
2	Ask for permission from holders that are non-commercial or permission-only: the Hermitage, the British Museum, the V&A, the Bodleian, Gallica, EMKP, the Qatar Digital Library, the Dunhuang Programme	Many grant free use for education when asked. Each grant is recorded with its scope, so the licence switch knows which build may use it	Letters and waiting. Groundwork Q22's enquiry template is the model
3	Public-domain day, every 1 January: the harvest rechecks licences yearly	Gaps close by themselves. On 1 January 2027, United States works published in 1931 enter the public domain, as do works by authors who died in 1956 in life-plus-70 countries	None; it is a scheduled job
4	Our own photographs in museums that allow photography, and of monuments where the law allows	Images we own of objects on public display	Each museum's visitor terms must allow reuse; freedom-of-panorama laws differ by country
5	Phone photogrammetry with free apps, of objects we may photograph, replicas, or makers' work with consent	Our own 3D models	Time; quality varies

#	Option	What it gets F1	What it costs instead
6	Student and university partnerships: design, architecture and archaeology students make drawings, maps, reconstructions, scans and translations as credited coursework under CC BY	Production at no cost, with real teaching value to them	Supervision and review time; results vary
7	Makers contribute, if they choose: living-practice holders share images or words under a licence they pick, credited, with a link to buy from them and no fee taken	Voices and images the record lacks	Never a condition; offered, not asked for as labour
8	The Wikimedia route: upload our own drawings and maps to Commons, request photographs through Commons and Wikipedia campaigns, and join museum partnership projects (GLAM-Wiki)	Free hosting, and volunteers who photograph and caption	Our uploads become reusable by anyone, which fits an open Atlas
9	Free hosting and serving: a static site; images served from holders' own IIIF servers where their terms allow; versioned data deposited on Zenodo with a DOI	No storage or bandwidth bill; the world set outlives the app	Dependence on holders' servers staying up; a fallback copy of what we may keep
10	AI inside the rules: drafting, alt text, audio description, first drafts in Arabic, all checked by a person	Speed on text work	Never generated images of historical objects, people or places (Scope v2 Q32)

#	Option	What it gets F1	What it costs instead
11	Money in, not out: cultural and education grants, in-kind licences, sponsored digitisation	Paid reads or permissions later, without breaking the zero-cost rule	Applications; optional

What F1 was still missing

The testing budget read seven outside benchmarks before looking at F1. They were the AP Art History 250 required works, Global Design History (2011), Margolin's World History of Design (2015), Smarthistory's Reframing Art History, the Met's Heilbrunn essay index, UNESCO's craft domains, and the Journal of Design History's special issues. It also read four Global South and decolonial sources.

The AP-250 test. Of the 250 works, 182 (73%) had a canon grouping for their own culture or movement; 92% matched at least a broad grouping, technique or object type; 20 matched nothing. Ancient Mediterranean, West and Central Asia, and South, East and Southeast Asia were fully covered. Africa (50%), the Pacific (55%) and later Europe and the Americas (57%) were the weakest.

The structural gap. Museums credit African, Pacific and Indigenous American works to peoples: Chokwe, Baule, Kwakwaka'wakw, Iatmul. The Atlas design has a "community, named in its own terms" grouping kind, but the canon had no rows of it. That is fixed: 300 communities, own names first (§4). The checker estimated full coverage rises to about 88% with them; the AP test is re-run after the next harvest.

Fourteen themes, each meeting the evidence rule (two benchmarks, or one benchmark and one source):

Theme	Home in F1
The designer as a profession, and how design was taught	A new unit, F1.19b (Q36); fallback, an R1 grouping page "schools of design"
The hierarchy of the arts (craft, art, design)	A case in F1.3, paired with F1.19b
Design and the nation, including after independence	An R1 grouping page and strand; cases in F1.17 and F1.20

Theme	Home in F1
Socialist, Soviet and Non-Aligned design after 1945	One of F1.20's plural modernisms
Coerced making: slavery, plantations, camps, prisons	A named strand in F1.23, with a content note
Tourist, souvenir and export arts	A strand across F1.17 and F1.2
Missions as making regimes	A strand across F1.16 and F1.17
Gardens and designed landscape	A grouping page; cases in F1.16 and F1.17
Furniture, interiors and the fashion system	F1.22a (furniture, the interior); F1.21 and F1.18 (fashion)
Settler-colonial design and identity	A case in F1.24; a paragraph each in F1.12 and F1.7
Geometry and mathematics as method	A strand in F1.15
Play and the child	A lens, with cases in F1.22a
Algorithmic making to generative AI	F1.5's recurrence chain, from the drawloom and Jacquard to generative models; F1.14 and F1.21 take training data as copying
Typography and type technology	F1.5's writing recurrence continued into F1.21, including Arabic, Chinese and Indic type

Rejected as already covered, or below the evidence rule: fakes and forgery (F1.14 and F1.24 hold them), animals as co-makers, acoustics, light, and standards and money.

Five sources were found only by bibliographic search: Graburn, Eglash, Brosterman, Fernández and Bonsiepe, and MoMA's *Toward a Concrete Utopia*. They are read before any claim from them enters a unit.

The canon after round 2: 4,228 nodes

Five families were missing from Scope v2's canon; all five now exist, plus 85 additions from the blind map. The canon holds 4,228 nodes in 24 kinds: 269 at R1, 1,268 at R2 and 2,691 at R3.

Family	Rows	What it adds	Fact-check
Communities	300	Peoples under their own names first (Diné, Kwakwaka'wakw, Yolŋu, Kānaka Maoli, Tsalagi), exonyms kept as other names, rejected names never used; at least three per sub-region	202 checked, 44 corrected: diacritics, a derogatory name used as a name, living peoples described only in the past, status groups framed as peoples
People	480	Makers, patrons, theorists, collectors, looters, restitution actors and named enslaved makers such as David Drake; 33% women, 62% working outside Europe and North America	204 checked, 23 corrected: two people listed as living had died, unsourced claims about living people softened
Places	419	Kilns, mines, workshops, ports, craft streets, sites and the museums that authored histories; at least five per sub-region	273 checked across places, events and periods, 39 corrected. UNESCO listings confirmed on UNESCO's site, and one false claim removed (Nimrud)
Events	294	Laws, bans, lootings, wars, restitutions, disasters and trade turning points; the last Great Zimbabwe bird's return on 15 April 2026	(with places)
Period definitions	220	Each tied to the region and tradition that defined it; contested labels marked	(with places)
Blind-map additions	85	Furniture types, typeface, Namban art, VNIITE, the department store, gardens, Plains ledger art and others	30 sampled, none wrong

The lesson from both rounds is where errors cluster. Random samples erred at 0–8%, but the rows that matter most — R1 and R2 rows, living people, endonyms and UNESCO claims — erred at 8–14%. So every such row is checked at source before a unit uses it

(template v3, step 14). The empty and thin cells of the coverage grid fell from 21 to 19; the six empty ones are the real absences named in Scope v2.

Five new grouping pages

Groundwork Q26 named the next five pages; all five are drafted, each with a nine-step walk, and the full text is in [Grouping pages](#). F1 now has eight of its planned 210 walks.

Page	Kind	Unit	Open objects read at source	Still to verify
The Indian Ocean	Network	F1.13	6 (Met Fustat cottons; Cleveland), plus a Geniza record	None with an East African findspot yet; dhow images; dates for Hormuz, Calicut, Aden and Malacca
Indus Valley civilisation	Civilisation, as commonly named: the model card for all 93	F1.9, F1.5	7 records (four Met seals bought in 1949, Cleveland 1964.104, a Nippur bead, a Damb Sadaat bowl) and a Commons photograph of weights; 2 Cleveland seals fail the 1970 test	No open weight record; five cities need place IDs
The waqf	Institution	F1.10, F1.17	7 (Met mosque lamps and Qur'an stand; Cleveland), one without pre-1970 history; no open endowment deed	How the lamps left Cairo; Mihrimah Sultan's deeds

Page	Kind	Unit	Open objects read at source	Still to verify
Arts and Crafts	Movement	F1.19, F1.20, F1.18	8 (Met, AIC, Cleveland); the Met's Strawberry Thief is not public domain	Where Merton Abbey's indigo came from
The Middle Horizon	Horizon	F1.7	8, including the Wari tunic WS-007 (passes the 1970 test with a caveat)	One Met record's pre-1970 history; no open Wari khipu

Three choices in the pages are worth your eye. The Middle Horizon card now gives both readings of Wari, empire or shared style, as the pre-read asked. The waqf walk gives both readings of Fatima al-Fihri's founding story. The Arts and Crafts walk sets an "extraction" reading of Morris's Indian sources beside an "exchange" reading.

Deep-dive template v3

Template v3 replaces v2 (Deep Dives 1 §7) for every remaining unit spec and deep dive. It keeps v2's twelve steps, folds in Groundwork's six cross-cutting pre-read fixes and the round-2 lessons, and adds three steps: people, visuals and a fact-check gate.

1. **Blind map.** What a specialist of this world or theme would insist on, plus the round-2 benchmarks for its area (the AP-250 content area; Global Design History; Heilbrunn).
2. **Responsibility block.** The sub-region × period cells, object types and canon groupings (civilisation names, communities, movements, networks) this unit must reach. Say which ones the taught path covers and which the world hub covers. The list comes from the workbook's grid, by canon ID.
3. **Protocol screen, before searching.** Never human remains, sacred or secret material, or anything a descendant community asks not to show. Other grave goods and altar objects are shown with their origin and a content note (Groundwork Q21). A Notice goes on every Indigenous community's material.
4. **Claims first.** Write 12–25 claims, each with a source, how deep that source goes, a confidence level, and both readings where contested. The chapter's device is declared as an interpretive claim. "Earliest known", never "first". No success criterion takes a side in a live debate.

5. **Nodes from the canon.** Every claim names the canon node that carries it. A missing node is added as a canon row, with a source and a review-log entry.
6. **Object verification.** Check the licence, the date, the 1970 test with the history-gap field, the colonial-context screen for objects made after 1800, the export-law line, the attribution as the museum records it beside our reading, and protocol. Outcome: exemplar, case or excluded. Also record the licence class, and a fallback for every restricted item (the licence switch).
7. **Living practice.** Its holders under their own name, sources dated by year, a consent route, and at least one source in the holders' own words. UNESCO status is harvested, never typed.
8. **People.** Name the makers where the record allows and write the credit line. Record who the credit leaves out, for F1.23's credit map.
9. **The walk.** 6–9 steps, each tied to claims and nodes, with content notes where needed.
10. **Visual plan, at zero cost.** For each step, the ladder rung the image comes from: open record, national licence, attribution licence, our own drawing, map or diagram, or a link out. No generated images of historical objects, people or places.
11. **Apply and the rest.** Apply by lane (Maker and Briefer), success criteria, three consumption forms, and links out.
12. **Readings.** The Historian's pre-read on pack v2, then a reciprocal reviewer. Sacred and contested steps are held back until a reader clears them; no paid reads.
13. **Writing check.** The twelve writing rules and the lint list: banned phrases, first-sentence length, and a claim for every sentence that states a fact.
14. **Fact-check gate.** Every R1 or R2 row the unit uses, every living person, every endonym, every UNESCO claim and every licence is checked at source. These rows err at 8–14% when drafted from memory.
15. **Registers.** The canon (new rows and review log), the world set, claims, practices, the link register, and a coverage-report row.

Historian pack v2: what changed

The [Historian Knowledge Pack](#) is now version 2, edited in place; version 1 stays in the doc's history. It answers Groundwork Q24 and the pre-read's finding that the pack lagged behind the deep dives.

- **Rules 13–20 added:** confidence in the words, "earliest known", perpetrators' terms, dated practices, names (the Gulf; Magan), civilisation as a label, harvested facts only, success criteria that do not take sides.
- **Two rules rewritten:** rule 7 now follows the Q21 funerary rule, and rule 9's human-flow rule covers every network, not only the Atlantic.
- **World briefs:** eleven chapters, Australia and the Pacific replacing "Oceania", each device declared as a reading, current counts, and "porcelain as the first global industry" rewritten as an argued claim.
- **System prompt v2**, carrying the new rules.
- **The F1.5 sample** now dates Egypt's earliest writing to about 3320 BCE, matching claims CL-102 and CL-203.
- **Six new evaluation cases (13–18):** first horses, the Maya civilisation, a Paracas mantle, a rejected name, 1897, and a UNESCO year.

Where F1 stands, and what is left

F1 is in phase 4 of workflow v3, between gates G1 (passed on 28 September) and G3. G2 is still open: Atlas Logic Q7–Q12 and your reaction to mockups v4.

Step	Done	Left
1–3 Study, research, evaluation	Six sprints; blind maps in sprint 3 and round 2; Scope v2	Research continues inside specs at 85/15
4–5 Critique, redesign	Structure v3.6, plus F1.9a and F1.12a	F1.19b if Q36 is agreed (structure v3.8)
6–9 Experience design	Atlas design v2 (Atlas Logic); mockups v4	G2: your answers to Q7–Q12 and the mockups
10 Unit specs	F1.17 exemplar; deep dives for 11 chapters; template v3	Specs for 25 units (26 with F1.19b), in three batches (Q42)
11 World set and data	64 records, 16 through the provenance pass; 110 claims; 4,228 canon nodes; 8 grouping pages	The harvest at scale (needs Q38); about 200 more walks, world by world

Step	Done	Left
12 Partner prompts	Historian pack v2	Packs for the other five voices F1's units use: Mirror, Client, Fabricator, Planet, Stranger (Q41)
Voice guide	The twelve writing rules	Your three writing samples, which set its tone
G3	—	Your review of specs and data, with a document audit
13–14 Production and test	—	Static Atlas first (Place, Time, Connections, Story, Grouping pages); then the app; accessibility, claims and licence checks; testers as planned in Phase 4 item 16

One gap in the workflow surfaced this round: F1's units assign five partner voices besides the Historian, and none of them has a pack yet. A unit cannot be tested without its voice, so the packs belong before G3.

The proposed spec batches (Q42):

1. **Batch 1:** F1.1–F1.4, F1.14, F1.15, F1.16, F1.18. These are Orientation and early Practice units; they set the pattern for the thematic units.
2. **Batch 2:** F1.19, F1.19a, F1.19b, F1.20, F1.21, F1.22, F1.22a, F1.23, F1.24. The modern and thematic spine, including most of the round-2 strands.
3. **Batch 3:** F1.25, F1.26, F1.27, F1.28, F1.28a, F1.29, F1.30, F1.30a, F1.31. The labs, method and Mastery units.

At program level, three items follow G3: the Master Structure register moves to F1's new version with its mapping; the Glossary gains the round-2 terms (community, endonym, licence class); and the Module Factory skill is written from F1's proven workflow before M2 starts.

Decisions for you

Q28 is answered (free now, able to charge later) and recorded in the Hub as decision 23. Seven new questions follow; "agree to all" or a list of exceptions is enough.

#	Question	Recommendation
Q36	Add F1.19b "The designer: how making split into designing, and how it was taught" as a Practice unit (structure v3.8)?	Yes. It is the learners' own lineage, and the canon already holds about 20 of its schools. Fallback: an R1 grouping page "schools of design" with a case in F1.17
Q37	Place the other thirteen themes as strands, cases and lenses in existing units, as in §3, with no further new units?	Yes
Q38	Set up the free harvest runtime: a public code repository under your GitHub account, with scheduled jobs that harvest and write the data files?	Yes. You create an empty public repository (for example "f1-atlas-data") or tell me to, and I set up the harvester, the schedule and the licence re-check. Until then, small pulls use the scraping connector, which spends your Firecrawl credits
Q39	Adopt the licence switch: six licence classes, an open and a commercial build from one dataset, and a fallback for every restricted item?	Yes; it puts your Q28 answer into practice
Q40	Send permission requests to the eight non-commercial or permission-only holders, from the project's address, recording each grant's scope?	Yes, batched with Groundwork Q22's two enquiries
Q41	Build packs for the five other partner voices F1 uses (Mirror, Client, Fabricator, Planet, Stranger), on the Historian pack's pattern, before G3?	Yes, after spec batch 1, so each pack is written against real units
Q42	Write the remaining unit specs in the three batches of §8, on template v3?	Yes; batch 1 starts now unless you say otherwise

Files and sources

- **F1_canon_register_v2.xlsx**: the canon at 4,228 nodes, with the summary, coverage grid, functions matrix, sources and primary texts; the counts are formulas.

- **F1_canon_v2.zip**: the CSVs, the five grouping pages as files, the round-2 blind map with the AP-250 coverage table, and every fact-check log.

Benchmarks read for the blind map:

- [College Board, AP Art History required works](#)
- [Margolin, World History of Design](#)
- [Smarthistory, Reframing Art History](#)
- [Heilbrunn Timeline essay index \(2019 archive\)](#)
- [UNESCO, traditional craftsmanship](#)
- [Journal of Design History, special issues](#)
- [Design History Society conferences](#)
- [Decolonising Design, editorial statement](#)
- [Fallan and Lees-Maffei, Designing Worlds](#)

The table of contents for Global Design History (Adamson, Riello and Teasley, 2011) was read from a third-party copy because the publisher's page has none. The Arab graphic design and Nonaligned Modernism sources were read through reviews only. Each grouping page lists the pages its writer opened.